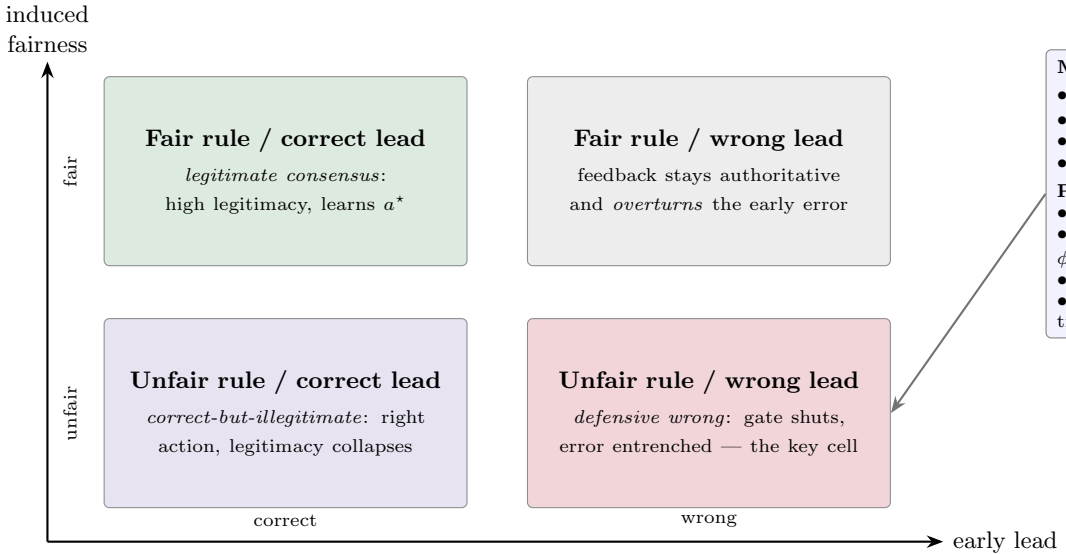


Model-based regressors

- legitimacy $L_{i,t}$ (latent)
- gated PE $\delta^{\text{eff}} = L\,\delta$
- fairness discrepancy $\Delta^F = R - \hat{M}$
- perceived benchmark $\hat{M}_{i,t}$

Predicted signatures

- learning rate $\propto$ inferred L, not accuracy
- below-benchmark erodes L faster ($\phi^- > \phi^+$)
- benchmark transmission $\Rightarrow$ polarisation
- defensive-wrong resists "better information"

Orthogonalisation. Manipulate perceived fairness *independently* of payoffs — shift the communicated modal-agent benchmark $\hat{M}$ (framing, reference information) at fixed reward rule — so the unfair-yet-correct-feedback cells are realisable. Core prediction: learning from identical reward feedback scales with *inferred legitimacy*, controlling for accuracy.